

HOUSE No. 4563

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES, October 2, 2025.

The committee on Education, to whom were referred the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 672) of Edward R. Philips that the Department of Elementary and Secondary Education be authorized to offer two hours of evidence based in-service suicide awareness and prevention training once every other year to certain employees and the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 699) of Danillo A. Sena and others for legislation to strengthen suicide prevention in schools, reports recommending that the accompanying bill (House, No. 4563) ought to pass.

For the committee,

KENNETH I. GORDON.

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In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to suicide prevention in schools.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. Chapter 71 of the General Laws is hereby amended by adding the following
2 section:

3 Section 98. (a) The department of elementary and secondary education shall adopt rules
4 to require in school health care providers and any holder of, or applicant for, an educator's
5 license in the commonwealth to receive at least 2 hours of evidence based in-service suicide
6 awareness and prevention training once every other year. This training shall be provided within
7 the framework of existing in-service training programs offered by the department or as part of
8 required professional development activities.

9 (1) Staff members subject to the training under paragraph (a) initially hired during a
10 school year in which the training is not required, shall be provided with suicide prevention and
11 identification materials for review by the local district within thirty days of being hired.

12 (b) The department shall, in consultation with the department of public health, the
13 department of mental health, and suicide prevention experts, develop a list of approved training
14 materials to fulfill the requirements of this section. The approved training materials must:

15 (1) be evidence-based; and

16 (2) demonstrated to be an effective or promising program.